

Defend free speech.
Fight surveillance.
Support innovation.
eff.org/donate



2026 EFF Award Winners: Access Now, 7amleh – The Arab Center for the Advancement of Social Media, DeFlock, and New Media Rights

Image by EFF (CC-by)

EFF is pleased to announce that Access Now, 7amleh – The Arab Center for the Advancement of Social Media, DeFlock, and New Media Rights have received 2026 EFF Awards for their vital work in ensuring that technology supports freedom, justice, and innovation for all people.

The EFF Awards recognize specific and substantial technical, social, economic, or cultural contributions in diverse fields including journalism, art, digital

access, legislation, technology development, and law.

[For the past 30 years](#), the EFF Awards—previously known as the Pioneer Awards—have recognized and honored key leaders in the fight for freedom and innovation online. Started when the internet was new, the Awards now reflect the fact that the online world has become both a necessity in modern life and a continually evolving set of tools for communication, organizing, creativity, and increasing human potential.

Supporting a global community advancing digital rights, defending digital access in crisis zones, empowering communities to take action against surveillance, and providing free legal assistance for creators and consumers to fight back against digital threats are high callings that help bring about a better tech future for all. We are pleased to honor these organizations with 2026 EFF Awards.

Access Now – Fostering Change in Human Rights and Technology



accessnow

[Access Now](#), founded in 2009 as an emergency response team helping Iranian activists get back online and communicate safely, has grown into one of the world's foremost organizations defending and extending the digital rights of people and communities at risk and supporting the global fight against technological repression.

Its 24/7 [Digital Security Helpline](#) offers real-time, direct technical assistance and advice to civil society groups and activists, media organizations, journalists and bloggers, and human rights defenders. It provides grants to frontline organizations working with people and communities most impacted by digital rights violations. It educates decision makers and pressures the powerful. And it organizes [RightsCon](#), a leading annual summit on human rights in the digital age, where activists, technologists, policymakers, business leaders, journalists, philanthropists, researchers, and artists can connect, collaborate, and drive change at the intersection of human rights and technology.

7amleh – The Arab Center for the Advancement of Social Media – Defending and Advancing Digital Access and Rights Across the MENA Region

حملة – المركز العربي
لتطوير الإعلام الاجتماعي

7amleh - The Arab Center for
the Advancement of Social Media



[7amleh – The Arab Center for the Advancement of Social Media](#) protects and expands digital access and rights for Palestinians and across the MENA region. The nonprofit investigates and monitors challenges to digital rights, focusing on internet access, privacy, freedom of expression and association online. It builds the capacity of activists, human rights defenders, and civil society organizations to provide training about digital rights, gender sensitive digital security, and effective online advocacy.

7amleh also advocates for changes to the digital rights policies and practices of governments, corporations and other influential institutions and individuals locally, regionally and internationally. It plans and manages advocacy and awareness-raising campaigns and builds networks and coalitions to promote access to safe, fair and free online spaces. For example, 7amleh has led the #ReconnectGaza campaign, supported by dozens of international NGOs [including EFF](#), to restore full internet access in Gaza – a crucial lifeline for residents, journalists, activists, and first responders.

DeFlock – Exposing the ALPR Surveillance Network

deflock

[DeFlock](#) is an open-source, volunteer-powered project that maps surveillance devices across the world, helping communities hold their governments and surveillance vendors accountable and understand where and how they're being watched. Founded in 2024 by software engineer and privacy advocate Will Freeman, DeFlock shines a light on the widespread use of automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology and the threats it poses to personal privacy and civil liberties.

DeFlock resources help people request public records, speak to local lawmakers, and take action against ALPR surveillance. Its work has helped foster a national grassroots community of anti-surveillance activists fighting back against this dangerous surveillance technology.

New Media Rights – Helping Creators Fight Back Against IP Bullies



[New Media Rights](#) (NMR) is a San Diego-based nonprofit program of California Western School of Law dedicated to defending digital rights through legal services, education, and public policy advocacy. Since its inception, NMR has been at the forefront of protecting creators, entrepreneurs, and internet users from digital threats such as copyright abuse, online harassment, and privacy violations.

In addition to providing free legal assistance, NMR has produced hundreds of freely available video and written legal education guides for creators and consumers, including the [Fair Use App](#) for filmmakers and video creators. It has participated in regulatory proceedings on net neutrality, Digital Millennium Copyright Act anti-circumvention, and copyright reform. Its work has also helped support access to public information and greater business and government accountability.

Discover more. Join our email list for EFF news, events, campaigns, and ways to support digital freedom.

POSTAL CODE (OPTIONAL)

EMAIL ADDRESS *

SIGN UP NOW

☐ I would like to join EFF's email list for EFF news, events, campaigns, and ways to support digital freedom.

ELECTRONIC FRONTIER FOUNDATION
eff.org
Creative Commons Attribution License